

The Q1 Equity Market Update 2024

Beauhurst

£2.42b
invested

-36%
from Q4 2023

+3.7%
from Q1 2023

492
deals completed

+1.4%
from Q4 2023

-18%
from Q1 2023

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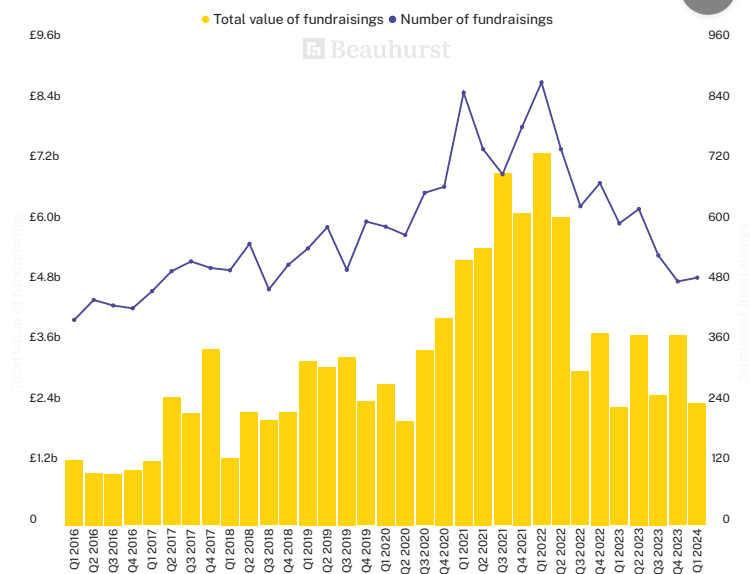
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The number of deals (162) was down 10% compared to Q1 2023 (180), but was slightly higher than Q1 2022 (159).

Turning it on its head, the total amount raised this Q1 (£2.42b) was significantly lower than Q4 2023 (£3.77b) — 36% lower. At first glance this might indicate a downward trajectory for 2024, but it is similar to the amount invested in Q1 2023 (£2.34b).

Time will tell whether investment volume will increase in Q2 2024 as it did in 2023; throughout the eight years we've been tracking this data, we've frequently seen Q1 as the lowest quarter for investment (aside from a particularly high Q1 2022). This quarter's result is therefore not a sure-fire indicator of a wider downturn in investment.

It may also indicate, as we've seen more and more in our recent analysis, that investors are opting to hold back on investments at this time. And, as we discussed in our yearly version of this report, [The Deal 2023](#), this uncertainty could be attributed to the 50 global elections being held in 2024, and their influence on the global markets.



Regional trends

In Q1 2024, high-growth companies in Scotland participated in 31 fundraising deals, equating to 6.4% of all deals. This corresponds to our findings in Q4 2023, where Scotland secured 31 deals. What's more impressive is the amount secured (£224m), which works out as 9.4% of the

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Deal sizes

The mean deal size for Q1 2024 was £4.92m, significantly higher than Q1 2023 (£3.89m), but still considerably lower than that in Q4 2023 (£7.78m).

Aside from Q4 2023, we've seen a reasonably consistent mean deal size of around £4-6m since the post-pandemic investment boom, which saw mean deal sizes peak at £10m in Q3 2021. This average size is consistent with those in 2019 and 2020, possibly indicating a return to the previous 'status quo' for deal sizes. However, with the Q4 2023 outlier, it'll become clearer at the end of 2024 if this is the case or if the average amount invested will rise again later in the year.



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hyperexponential

Amount: £57.0m
Deal Date: 11 January 2024
Location: London
Industry: Software, financial services

hyperexponential develops pricing software for insurers. It secured £57m in January 2024 and has featured on two high-growth lists since 2020, as well as attending the Lloyd's Lab accelerator in 2019.



ElevenLabs

Amount: £63.0m
Deal Date: 22 January 2024
Location: London
Industry: Software

ElevenLabs raised £63m in January 2024. It has developed an AI tool that generates audio content from text in multiple different languages. It launched in 2022 and since then has raised a total of £79.5m, as well as attending the Disney Accelerator.



Storegga



Tokamak Energy

Amount: £65.2m
Deal Date: 8 January 2024
Location: London
Industry: Renewable energy

[Storegga](#) specialises in renewable energy technology, focusing on carbon capture, carbon reduction, and the transportation of stored carbon. Their aim is to help the private sector transition to a sustainable future. Storegga has hit two of our [ESG Signals](#): clean & renewable energy and green infrastructure & building.

Amount: £76.5m
Deal Date: 8 January 2024
Location: Oxfordshire
Industry: Renewable energy, nuclear energy

Based in Oxfordshire, [Tokamak Energy](#) is an academic spinout of the [Culham Centre for Fusion Energy](#). The company develops fusion technologies in hopes of advancing the development of large scale clean energy production. It has hit three of our Innovation Signals and our clean & renewable energy ESG Signal.



Rocco Forte Hotels

Amount: £86.2m
Deal Date: 17 January 2024
Location: London



Build A Rocket Boy

Amount: £87.0m
Deal Date: 16 January 2024
Location: Edinburgh

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Amount: £339m
Deal Date: 5 March 2024
Location: London
Industry: Banking, software

[Monzo](#) has quickly become one of the world's leading challenger banks and a household name. First marketed as a great card to use abroad, Monzo has now expanded into an extensive offering that includes borrowing and investment options. It raised £339m in March 2024, bringing its total fundraisings secured to £1.27b since its establishment in 2015.

About the authors



LILY RUAAH

in

Lily is a Content Associate and professional writer. She is responsible for content creation at Beauhurst and specialises in both creative and analytical writing. Prior to this, she worked as an SEO Content Writer and completed an MA in Creative Writing.



BEN HYDE

in

Ben is a Graphic Designer, creating everything from branding materials to visual content for Beauhurst's blog and long-form reports. He has a keen eye for detail and a passion for good design. Ben holds a BA in Graphic Design from the University of Cumbria.



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